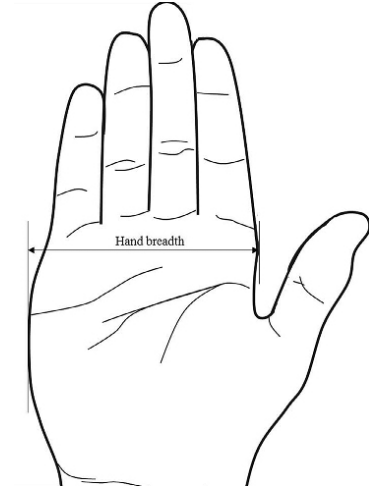


## The cubit throughout the Bible

The cubit throughout the Bible does not always represent the same measurement unit. Some instances, like in [Ezekiel](#) are explicit and some like [2Ch 3:3](#) are not.

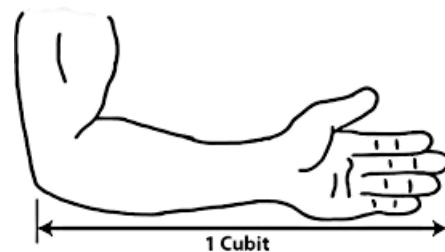
An handbreath is the width of four fingers pressed together (standardized to 3")



A span is the distance from thumb to pinky



A (common) cubit is the distance from the elbow to the fingertip *of a man*



| Reference                       | Notes                                                                                                       | Common name                   | Handbreadths (3" each) |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------|
| Gen 6:15                        | First mention of "cubit". The Ark. Built by men.                                                            | Very likely the common cubit* | 6*                     |
| Exo 25-27                       | The Tabernacles dimensions. Built by men.                                                                   | Common cubit                  | 6 (~18")               |
| Deu 3:11                        | "after the cubit of a man"                                                                                  | Common cubit                  | 6                      |
| 2Ch 3:3 (1Ki 6:2)               | "after the first measure"<br>Solomon's temple. Built by men.                                                | Common cubit                  | 6                      |
| Eze 40:5                        | "by the cubit and an hand breadth"<br>The future, millennial temple. Built by God and men (Zec 6:12,13,15). | Long cubit                    | 7                      |
| Eze 43:13                       | "the cubit is a cubit and an hand breadth". The future, millennial temple.                                  | Long cubit                    | 7                      |
| Mat 6:27, Luke 12:25, John 21:8 | Jesus didn't explicitly use the long cubit and the multitude used the common cubit.                         | Common cubit                  | 6                      |
| Rev 21:17                       | "according to the measure of a man, that is, of the angel" (Mat 22:30, Mar 12:25, Luk 20:36)                | Common cubit                  | 6                      |

\* Why the cubit for the Ark was very likely the common cubit:

- 2Ch 3:3 "after the **first** measure"
  - If there was more than "*one measure*" of the cubit before 2Ch 3:3 (chronologically) we would have no way of proving which one was the "*first measure*". Thus, Deu 3:11 "*after the cubit of a man*" (and every other cubit before 2Ch 3:3) is the same as "*the first measure*".
  - Until we get to Ezekiel where we are given the "long/royal" cubit which clearly states "*by the [common] cubit and an handbreath*". If "*the cubit*" was anything but the common cubit before Ezekiel, then Ezekiel's "long/royal" cubit would be instead 8 handbreadths which doesn't make sense.

Notes:

- The Siloam (Shiloah; Isa 8:6, Luk 13:4, Joh 9:7,11; H7975, G4611) inscription (Hezekiah's tunnel; ~2700yrs ago) reads "...and there flowed the waters from the spring to the pool for a thousand two hundred cubits...". That distance has been measured in modern times to be 1,750 feet.
  - $1750 / 1200 = 1.458\bar{3}$
  - $1.458\bar{3} \times 12 = 17.5$  inches (per cubit)
    - Remember, we don't know exactly where the builders of Hezekiah's tunnel began and ended their measurement and that there was roughly 2700 years of erosion between the two measurements.
    - $17.5\text{in.} \times 1200\text{cu.} = 21,000\text{in.}$
    - $18\text{in.} \times 1200\text{cu.} = 21,600\text{in.}$ 
      - The difference between using a 18in. cubit and using a 17.5in. cubit is 2.77%